TAGLIATELLE ALLA BOLOGNESE

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
North	**4-6**	**4 h plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

170 g	Pancetta, in one slab
370 g	Onion
150 g	Carrot, peeled
150 g	Celery
454 g	Ground beef
454 g	Ground pork
454 g	Ground veal
56 g	Olive oil
130 g	Tomato paste
220 g	Dry white wine
474 g	Water
237 g	Milk
1 batch	Egg dough
30 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
45 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated

METHOD

1. Chill the meat grinder and its small die in the refrigerator at least 1 hour, or 30 minutes in the freezer.
2. Fit the small die and run the pancetta through twice. Set it aside.
3. Cut the onion, carrot and celery into pieces 1/2 to 1 inch across and grind all three. Gather the ground vegetables in cheesecloth and wring the liquid out. That is the soffritto.
4. Set a large heavy saucepot or Dutch oven over low heat and render the pancetta 5 to 8 minutes. It should be cooked through but neither browned nor crisp.
5. Add the beef, pork and veal, raise the heat to medium-high, and saute about 5 minutes, breaking the meat up with a wooden spoon, until lightly browned.
6. Turn off the heat. Tip the meat into a bowl and scrape any brown bits out of the pot.
7. Back on low heat, add the oil and the soffritto. Cook 5 to 8 minutes, stirring often, until soft but with no color. Work in the tomato paste for 1 to 2 minutes, then return the meat and stir it through.
8. Pour in the wine and cook 2 to 3 minutes, until it has dropped by about half and the alcohol has gone.
9. Add the water and hold the pot at a very low simmer for 2 to 3 hours. Look at it every 30 minutes and top up with water so it never dries out, browns or catches on the base. It is done when the meat is completely soft, the flavors have come together, and the ragù coats the spoon thickly.
10. Off the heat, stir the milk in. The ragù should take on a sheen.
11. Weigh out 512 g of ragù for the pasta. The rest keeps 5 days in a sealed container in the refrigerator, or freezes.
12. Make 624 g of tagliatelle from the egg dough.
13. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to a boil over high heat.
14. Set a large saute pan over low heat and stir the 512 g of ragù together with 1 to 2 ladles of pasta water (55 to 115 g).
15. Once it is warm, stir in the butter and set the pan aside.
16. Cook the tagliatelle 30 seconds to 1 minute. It should come out tender, not soft.
17. Lift the pasta into the saute pan with tongs or a pasta basket and raise the heat to medium. Add another 1 to 2 ladles of pasta water (55 to 115 g) and fold gently with a large spoon for 30 seconds to 1 minute. A splash more water loosens it if it tightens.
18. Off the heat, fold in half the parmigiano, loosening with a little more pasta water if it needs it. The meat ought to cling to the pasta, with the sauce still glossy.
19. Divide between bowls and finish with the rest of the parmigiano.

NOTES

Tomato paste rather than tinned tomato is the choice here, because it brings sweetness and tomato flavor without putting liquid into the pot.
Wringing the ground soffritto in cheesecloth drives off its water, so the vegetables soften rather than stew.
The meat is browned, lifted out, and the pot scraped clean before the soffritto goes in, so the ragù never picks up a roasted edge over the following hours.
The batch makes far more ragù than the dish needs. Only 512 g is dressed with pasta.
Leftover dressed pasta fries well. Oil in a pan over high heat, both sides, until it crusts, which is tagliatelle ripassate in padella.

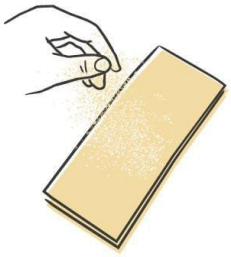
SHAPE
Tagliatelle

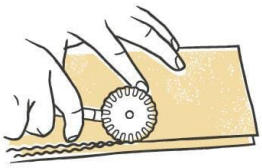
Region: Emilia-Romagna and neighboring regions. Called fettuccine in Lazio / Rest: 20-30 min at room temperature

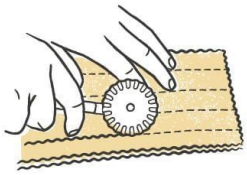
METHOD

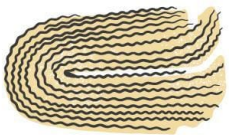
1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Give a wooden work surface a light dusting of 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Knife the sheets into 12-inch lengths and trim the ragged edges off. Save the trim for soup.
4. Dust each sheet lightly with 00 flour and stack them neatly two or three high. Run a fluted pastry cutter around every edge of the stack so all the edges come out ruffled.
5. Starting at the long edge of the stack, cut 1/2-inch strands working inward. A ruler or straightedge keeps the lines even while you get used to the fluted cutter.
6. Dust the strands generously with 00 flour and shake them apart. Bend the batch into a horseshoe and set it on the pan.
7. Repeat with the rest of the sheets.
8. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
9. To hold, cover the pan with plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

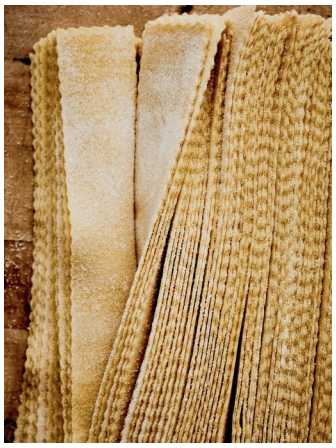
SHAPING


1


2


3


4


5


6

NOTES

Cut width is 1/2 inch, with a fluted pastry cutter.
Bologna's Accademia Italiana della Cucina specifies 1/3 inch. Robbins goes wider on purpose, because her tagliatelle and her fettuccine are rolled to the same thinness and the width is what separates them. Widths vary across the region anyway.
The fluted cutter is Robbins' own distinction for this shape, not a traditional requirement.
Sheets are 12 inches long, stacked two or three high to cut.
Shaped into a horseshoe rather than a nest.
Refrigerated shelf life is 24 hours.
Suits a hearty ragu, or light butter-and-cheese sauces carrying seasonal vegetables such as mushrooms or zucchini.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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